

Virgin had virtually no investment. The entire backend was handled by the bank. All Virgin provided was the brand and helped with the marketing—very little cash invested. In return, it got a good chunk of the profits. Heads, I win; tails, I don't lose much!

Branson owns his own private island in the British Virgin Islands called Necker Island.⁶ It is a spectacular property and was featured in the last episode of *The Rebel Billionaire* on Fox. The island was on sale for £3,000,000 a few years ago. Branson's starting offer: £150,000—95 percent off the list price. His offer was laughed at, but a few weeks later he bought the island for just £180,000. Needless to say, Sir Richard has had a very spectacular Dhandho return on his vacation home investment over the years. Now you and 13 other friends can spend time on Necker Island for just \$30,000 *per night*.⁷

With minimal downsides, failure rates don't matter to Sir Richard Branson. Even if half these ventures fail or never scale up, it doesn't matter. There's virtually no money put into them to begin with. Venture capitalists ought to look at the Virgin model because the Virgin model is the VC model of the future. Branson is an ultra low-risk, ultra high-return VC. People keep feeding him ideas, and he acts on a select few. He gets large equity stakes, sometimes 50/50 equity stakes in these businesses without putting any money in them. In some cases, like Virgin Atlantic, it is a 100 percent stake with very little invested.

There are two words that encapsulate Branson's journey: Virgin Dhandho. Like his "twin" brothers Manilal and Papa Patel, Branson is all about: Heads, I win; tails I don't lose much!